Prepflow

DAILY EDITION · FOR TONY DIBBIN

Tuesday, 13 October 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON	BIRMINGHAM	MANCHESTER	GLASGOW
Drizzle	Overcast	Drizzle	Rain
20° 15°	18° 12°	17° 12°	17° 10°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 **The Prime Minister has summoned Iran's ambassador, warning that Britain will not tolerate threats on our soil.**

This follows an incident at RAF Fairford, which the Prime Minister says was "almost certainly" directed by Iran's Islamic Revolutionary Guard. The UK is taking the matter extremely seriously.

POLITICS · UK

2 **The government faces a massive £35 billion Budget challenge to meet its spending pledges, according to a leading think tank.**

The Institute for Fiscal Studies warns that billions more will be needed if the government wants to stick to its current spending plans. This could mean difficult decisions ahead.

ECONOMY · UK

3 **A health and safety inquiry is underway after a man was fatally attacked by a tiger at Yorkshire Wildlife Park.**

The park remains shut following the tragic incident on Saturday. Authorities are now investigating exactly what happened.

INCIDENT · UK

4 **A public inquiry will examine the deaths of two men in the Manchester synagogue attack, the Home Secretary has confirmed.**

Melvin Cravitz and Adrian Daulby were killed in the attack. The inquiry will aim to provide answers and ensure lessons are learned.

INVESTIGATION · UK

5 **The King, Queen, and Prince William are set to visit Aberfan to mark the 60th anniversary of the devastating disaster.**

The tragedy in 1966 saw a colliery spoil tip collapse, killing 116 children and 28 adults. The royal visit will honour those lost and the community.

ROYAL · UK

02 — SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

1 **Sacha Baron Cohen is set to star in Quentin Tarantino's new West End play, 'The Popinjay Cavalier'.**

The 'Borat' star expressed his delight at working with the 'Pulp Fiction' director on the theatrical production. It promises to be a must-see show.

> ON AIR — Are you excited to see Sacha Baron Cohen on the West End stage in a Quentin Tarantino play? What kind of character do you think he'll play?

THEATRE · COMING UP

2 **Robert Pattinson is starring in a new film, 'Primetime', exploring how hunting predators became a hit TV show.**

The actor portrays the real-life host of the American TV programme 'To Catch a Predator'. It sounds like a fascinating and intense role for him.

> ON AIR — Robert Pattinson taking on such a unique, real-life role – are you intrigued to see how he tackles it?

FILM · COMING UP

3 **A post-war sculpture by Barbara Hepworth, inspired by the Cornish landscape, could fetch up to £8 million at auction.**

The significant piece of art is going under the hammer, attracting attention from collectors worldwide. It highlights the enduring value of British art.

> ON AIR — If you had £8 million, would you bid on a sculpture like this, or is modern art not your thing?

ART · COMING UP

4 **A new documentary offers unprecedented access to K-Pop idol Lisa Manobal of Blackpink as a race scandal erupted.**

Film-maker Sue Kim shares insights into being with Lisa during a candid and challenging time. It promises a rare look behind the scenes of global stardom.

> ON AIR — Are you a fan of K-Pop and Blackpink? Would you be interested in a documentary that shows the highs and lows of a global star?

DOCUMENTARY · COMING UP

5 **US singer-songwriter Ashe has revealed the personal story behind her international smash hit, 'Stop The Wedding'.**

She admitted she was too scared to cancel her own wedding, and that experience became the inspiration for the song. It's a powerful story of turning personal struggle into art.

> ON AIR — Have you ever been in a situation where you felt you couldn't back out of something, even if you wanted to? What's the most relatable song you've heard recently?

MUSIC · NEW RELEASE

03 — SPORT

On the schedule

1 **The Lionesses take a two-goal lead into the second leg of their Women's World Cup qualifying play-off against Greece.**

While it's a strong position, some are asking if England lacked ruthlessness in front of goal. They'll be looking to seal their qualification convincingly.

ON AIR — Do you think the Lionesses sometimes lack that killer instinct in front of goal, or is a two-goal lead perfectly fine?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 **Coventry City have stunned Newcastle United with a fantastic 4-1 victory, claiming their first Premier League home win in 25 years!**

It was an emphatic performance from Coventry, giving their fans a long-awaited reason to celebrate. What a result for the Sky Blues!

ON AIR — Coventry fans, how good does it feel to finally get that Premier League home win after so long? What was your favourite moment from the game?

FOOTBALL · UK

3 **Alexander Zverev is guaranteed to finish his 2026 season as the men's tennis world number one.**

This comes after Carlos Alcaraz suffered a surprise defeat in Shanghai, securing the top spot for Zverev. A fantastic achievement for the German star.

ON AIR — Is Zverev a deserving world number one, or were you hoping for a different player to take the top spot this year?

TENNIS · GLOBAL

4 **Lauren Price is set to fight Michaela Kotaskova in Cardiff in November, with exciting plans hinted at for early 2027.**

The British boxer has ruled out facing American star Claressa Shields for now. It sounds like a big year is on the horizon for Price.

ON AIR — Are you looking forward to seeing Lauren Price fight in Cardiff, and who would you like to see her challenge in 2027?

BOXING · UK

5 **Great Britain's youngest Olympic medal winner, Sky Brown, has won silver at the World Skate Games in Paraguay.**

This impressive performance boosts her hopes for qualifying for the LA 2028 Olympics. She continues to be an incredible talent.

ON AIR — Sky Brown is just phenomenal, isn't she? Do you think she'll be bringing home more Olympic medals in 2028?

SKATEBOARDING · GLOBAL

04 — NEWSBRIEF

Quick hits

1 **A new trend sees people rediscovering the simple joy of collecting interesting pebbles and shells from British beaches.**
It's a delightful way to connect with nature and bring a little bit of the seaside home, without costing a penny. Many are turning their finds into decorative displays.

2 **The comforting clinking sound of ice in a glass is being recognised as a surprising stress-reducer.**
Research suggests that these small, familiar noises can have a calming effect, creating a moment of peace in our busy days. Who knew a simple drink could be so therapeutic?

3 **There's a growing appreciation for the charming imperfections of 'wonky fruit and veg' in our supermarkets.**
Shoppers are increasingly choosing produce that might not look picture-perfect but tastes just as delicious, helping to reduce food waste and champion natural beauty.

4 **The satisfying pop of opening a new jar of coffee is becoming a small moment of daily pleasure for many.**
That distinctive seal-break and the rush of aroma signal the start of a fresh brew and a moment of quiet enjoyment. It's the little things, isn't it?

5 **British pet owners are increasingly sharing short, joyful videos of their pets reacting to unusual sounds.**
From a quirky toy to a distant siren, these clips offer a hilarious glimpse into our furry friends' personalities and their sometimes bewildered expressions.

6 **The nostalgic art of 'writing a proper letter' is making a comeback amongst younger generations.**
There's something wonderfully personal about receiving a handwritten note, and many are finding it a charming way to connect in a digital world.

7 **A surge in interest for 'vintage board games' is bringing families back together for screen-free fun.**
Digging out those classic games from the loft or finding them in charity shops offers a delightful trip down memory lane and hours of good old-fashioned entertainment.

05 — TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q **Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to having a particular 'odd ritual' they absolutely have to do before enjoying a new box of breakfast cereal, especially if it's a fancy, artisan one. What is it?**

ANSWER: POURING A TINY, 'TESTER' AMOUNT FIRST, JUST TO GET A FEEL FOR THE TEXTURE AND CRUNCH BEFORE COMMITTING TO A FULL BOWL!

Q **Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when trying to quickly judge if a new brand of shower gel will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific? What is it?**

ANSWER: GIVING THE BOTTLE A LITTLE 'SQUEEZE AND SNIFF' TEST, HOPING TO GET A HINT OF ITS LATHERING POTENTIAL AND SCENT, OFTEN MAKING A LITTLE 'HMM' SOUND!

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes you discover a 'hidden gem' of a local walk or green space, perhaps a little park or a quiet footpath, that you just adore?**
  What's your favourite local hidden gem, and what makes it so special to you? We'd love to hear about the lovely spots right on your doorstep!

- **We all have that 'one particular item in our fridge or cupboard' that, no matter how long it's been there, we just can't bring ourselves to throw away – 'just in case' we need it!**
  What's that 'just in case' item lingering in your kitchen, and what fantastical scenario are you holding onto it for? Let us know!

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY — LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Space.** There are more stars in the universe than grains of sand on all the beaches on Earth.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The Eiffel Tower can grow taller in the summer due to the expansion of its iron structure in the heat, by as much as 15 centimetres.

06 — LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 — FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A group of rhinos is called a 'crash', which seems rather fitting for such large, powerful animals.
- The world's largest hot desert is the Sahara, covering an area of over 9 million square kilometres.
- Bananas are technically berries, while strawberries are not, according to botanical definitions.
- The distinctive smell of old books comes from the breakdown of paper over time, releasing various organic compounds.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time, equal to one hundredth of a second in computing or the time it takes for light to travel one centimetre in physics.
- The human nose can detect over a trillion different scents, far more than previously thought.
- The first successful photograph was taken in 1826 by Joseph Nicéphore Niépce.
- The shortest complete sentence in the English language is said to be 'Go!'.

08 — TODAY'S DAY NOTES TUE 13 OCT 2026

On this day

Day 286 of the year, 79 days left in 2026. Today Azerbaijani Railway Day (Azerbaijan); Christian feast day: Blessed Alexandrina of Balasar; Christian feast day: Chelidonia; Christian feast day: Edward the Confessor (translation). Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1947 — Sammy Hagar, American singer-songwriter, guitarist, and producer
- 1968 — Tisha Campbell-Martin, American actress and singer
- 1941 — John Snow, English cricketer
- 1944 — Robert Lamm, American singer-songwriter, pianist, and producer
- 1952 — Beverly Johnson, American model, actress, and singer
- 1961 — Rachel De Thame, English gardener and television presenter
- 1981 — Kele Okereke, English singer, songwriter, and musician
- 1947 — Joe Dolce, American-Australian singer-songwriter and guitarist

THE DAY TODAY

- 1943 — World War II: Marshal Pietro Badoglio announces that Italy has officially declared war on Germany.
- 1908 — Margaret Travers Symons bursts into the UK parliament and becomes the first woman to speak there.
- 1892 — Edward Emerson Barnard is first to discover a comet by photographic means.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1946 — France adopts the constitution of the Fourth Republic.
- 1972 — Aeroflot Flight 217 crashes outside Moscow, killing 174.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1921 — Soviet republics sign the Treaty of Kars to formalize the borders between Turkey and the South Caucasus states.
- 1976 — The first electron micrograph of an Ebola virus is taken at the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention by Dr. F. A. Murphy.

- 2019 — Kenyan Brigid Kosgei sets a new world record for a woman runner with a time of 2:14:04 at the 2019 Chicago Marathon.

09 — TOMORROW'S DAY NOTES WED 14 OCT 2026

A peek at tomorrow

Day 287 of the year, 78 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Angadrisma; Christian feast day: Fortunatus of Todi; Christian feast day: Joseph Schereschewsky (Episcopal Church (USA)); Christian feast day: Pope Callixtus I. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1940 — Cliff Richard, Indian-English singer-songwriter and actor
- 1980 — Amjad Khan, Danish-English cricketer
- 1980 — Ben Whishaw, English actor
- 1988 — Max Thieriot, American actor
- 1978 — Usher, American singer-songwriter, dancer, and actor
- 1968 — Matthew Le Tissier, English footballer and journalist
- 1990 — Jordan Clark, English cricketer
- 1978 — Steven Thompson, Scottish footballer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1968 — Apollo program: The first live television broadcast by American astronauts in orbit is performed by the Apollo 7 crew.
- 2014 — The Serbia vs. Albania UEFA qualifying match is canceled after 42 minutes due to several incidents on and off the pitch. Albania is eventually awarded a win.
- 1966 — The Dutch Cals cabinet fell after Norbert Schmelzer, the leader of the government party, filed a successful motion against the budget, in what later became known as the Night of Schmelzer.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1994 — Yasser Arafat, Yitzhak Rabin and Shimon Peres receive the Nobel Peace Prize for their role in the establishment of the Oslo Accords and the framing of future Palestinian self government.
- 1981 — Vice President Hosni Mubarak is elected as the President of Egypt, one week after the assassination of Anwar Sadat.

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10 — FORWARD PLANNING · FILM

Coming to cinemas

OCTOBER 2026 · PREVIEW

FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING · SPORT

On the sporting calendar

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